



REUTERS/PAWAN KUMAR

SECRET BALLOT: Mayawati

her, just as Mulayam Singh Yadav used to blame the Congress for conspiring to kill him and tapping his phones before the Assembly elections. She launched a counter-offensive against the CBI, which has found "clinch- ing evidence" against her in the disproportionate assets case. Mayawati also hit out at the UPA Government for trying to send her to prison.

The rally was a set- back for the Communists and Ajit Singh's Rashtriya Lok Dal, who had rallied behind her in an attempt to topple the UPA Govern- ment over the nuclear deal. By saying that the BSP would contest all 80 Lok Sabha seats in Uttar Pradesh alone, Mayawati has dumped her new-found allies.

To secure a firm standing as the prime ministerial candidate, the chief minister should perhaps learn coalition politics first if she wants to fulfil her dream of ruling the country.

by Subhash Mishra

SIGNPOSTS

RESIGNED: C. Rangarajan, chairman of the Economic Advisory Council. He is to be nominated to the Rajya Sabha and will be suc- ceeded by Suresh Tendulkar.



CONFERRED: On industri- alist **Ratan Tata** the Degree of Doctor of Science

(Honoris Causa) by President Pratibha Patil.

WON: By **Delhi College of Engineering**, the Most Improved Design Award for 2008 for a new- generation robotic submarine. The event was organised by the Association for Vehicle System International and the Office of Naval Research, USA.

BARRED: By the Supreme Court, Britons **Duncan Grant** and **Alan Waters**, from leaving India. They were acquitted by the Bombay High Court in a case re- lated to molesting boys at shelters for the homeless.

Heir Apparent

LUCKNOW While address- ing the BSP's national convention here on August 9, Chief Minister Mayawati dropped a bombshell. She declared that she has already named her successor who is 20 years her junior. However, the "succes- sor's" identity is shrouded in mystery—she refused to name him, saying that she has handed over en- velopes to two top BSP leaders with his name in them. She even declined to name the two leaders.

The announcement

may just be a gimmick to pacify her Dalit support- ers, who are resenting that the chief minister is giving weightage to upper castes. Mayawati reiter- ated that her successor will be from among the Dalits, not from an upper caste. She also projected herself as a prime min- isterial candidate, moti- vating party workers to work for their "mission" to see India's first Dalit prime minister.

Mayawati lambasted the Congress and the BJP for conspiring to eliminate

VIS-A-VIS **LALU PRASAD YADAV** Rashtriya Janata Dal president **versus** **ARUN JAITLEY** BJP general secretary

SIMI should not be banned. If it has to be banned, the Shiv Sena and Durga Vahini should also be banned.



SAURABHI SINGH



If leaders like him openly support SIMI, one can only wonder about the Government's resolve to suppress terrorism.

EPILOGUE: Reigning in terror requires stronger measures than just banning an outfit.